

PRELUDE XXIII

A THREE-PART Invention (Sinfonia) on a single figure with its inversion, and with a fourth part added in the last three bars. The rising crotchets, which in the inner voice follow the lines of the semiquaver figure, come to the surface as the semiquavers go into the lower parts. A quiet singing *legato* should give breathing-space to the semiquaver rests, and should admit of swelling out sonorously and freely. In bar 18 it is very important that the bass should be distinctly heard to fall from G# to A#; as the effect of a connection between G# and F# would be that of a particularly bad pair of fifths. The minim F# should therefore have very little tone.

This is the only Prelude in *Das Wohltemperirte Klavier* which may, without fantastic assertion, be argued to have a more than casual thematic resemblance to its Fugue.

FUGUE XXIII

THE Subject may perhaps be distinctly phrased with a breath after the C#, which will show its resemblance to the Prelude. The trill on the minim should be given wherever possible, or represented by a single w; even with the Inverted Subject a trill or a mordent (ψ) is appropriate there.

The Countersubject is as important as the Subject. A new semiquaver figure casually completing the harmony in the alto at the end of bar 7, is inverted and made the basis of all the Episodes. These consist of an independent sequential group in triple counterpoint. It is heard three times, and is always the same length of $2\frac{1}{2}$ bars: first in bars 9-11; then bars 13 $\frac{1}{2}$ -15, and lastly in bars 26-28. Its semiquaver figure is used in several other places as a counterpoint, and has the last word in the tenor at the final cadence.

The Inverted Subject (foreshadowed in the bass of bar 16) appears twice, in the soprano in bars 18-19, answered by the alto in bars 20-21.

The *tempo* is quietly flowing. Eight in the bar would be too slow for the Episodes and for the unusual regularity of the entries; but a very deliberate four in the bar is required for the rhythmic well-being of the Countersubject. The touch should be a sonorous *legato* in which the upper parts can shine without hardness in the many passages in which they are high with a wide gap between them and the lower ones. The Fugue is specially full of fine tone-colour produced merely by bold use of all possible positions of its four parts. The player should be conscious of them all, as being his means of contrast.